

Skillomate Android Permission Fix - Build Comparison

Report date: 2026-09-12. Scope: Skillomate mobile project only, under appcopyai.

Summary

The rejected Android broad media/storage permissions were traced to native and dependency manifests, then removed from the final Android release using Expo blockedPermissions and Android manifest-merger removal rules. Android versionCode is 2, public version remains 1.0, and iOS build number is configured as 12.

Area	Previous build/config	New build/config
Android package	com.skillomate.app	com.skillomate.app
Android versionName	1.0	1.0
Android versionCode	1 on the rejected Play bundle. The native project was already at 2 before this pass.	2
iOS bundle id	com.alihussainkhan.edunexfinal	com.alihussainkhan.edunexfinal
iOS marketing version	1.0	1.0
iOS build number	11	12
Android release artifact	Rejected AAB contained READ_MEDIA_IMAGES.	EAS production AAB finished and downloaded locally.
Android APK artifact	Older local unsigned APK existed in build outputs.	EAS internal APK finished and downloaded locally.

Permission Source Analysis

- READ_MEDIA_IMAGES was introduced by expo-screen-capture 57.0.3. Its Android manifest declares android.permission.READ_MEDIA_IMAGES for Android 13, and Gradle manifest-merger blame confirmed host.exp.exponent:expo.modules.screencapture:57.0.3 as the transformed dependency source.
- READ_EXTERNAL_STORAGE and WRITE_EXTERNAL_STORAGE were present directly in android/app/src/main/AndroidManifest.xml and were also contributed by expo-file-system. After adding expo-image-picker, expo-image-picker also contributed legacy storage permissions and CAMERA.
- No launchCameraAsync call was found, and Skillomate currently has no working take-photo profile flow, so CAMERA was explicitly removed too.
- The only requestMediaLibraryPermissionsAsync call now present is guarded by Platform.OS === "ios". Android opens launchImageLibraryAsync without requesting gallery or storage permission.

Files Changed

- appcopyai/App.js - added Expo image picker import, Android permission-free profile picker flow, iOS-only media permission request, app-storage copy for selected images, and URI avatar rendering.
- appcopyai/android/app/src/main/AndroidManifest.xml - added tools namespace and tools:node="remove" entries for READ_MEDIA_IMAGES, READ_MEDIA_VIDEO, READ_EXTERNAL_STORAGE, WRITE_EXTERNAL_STORAGE, and CAMERA.
- appcopyai/app.json - added android.blockedPermissions, bumped iOS buildNumber from 11 to 12, and added the iOS photo library usage description.
- appcopyai/eas.json - added production-apk profile for signed APK generation.
- appcopyai/package.json and appcopyai/package-lock.json - added expo-image-picker 57.0.17.
- appcopyai/ios/Podfile.lock - resolved ExpolImagePicker pod 57.0.17.
- appcopyai/ios/ProtectedVideo/Info.plist - added NSPhotoLibraryUsageDescription.
- appcopyai/ios/ProtectedVideo.xcodeproj/project.pbxproj - bumped CURRENT_PROJECT_VERSION from 11 to 12.
- appcopyai/releases/android/Skillomate-1.0-vc2-production.aab - downloaded EAS production AAB artifact.
- appcopyai/releases/android/Skillomate-1.0-vc2-production.apk - downloaded EAS signed APK artifact.

Verification

- npx expo-doctor: 20/20 checks passed. No issues detected. The appConfigFieldsNotSyncedCheck remains disabled in package.json as it was before.
- Local Gradle :app:processReleaseManifest and :app:bundleRelease completed successfully using Android Studio JBR and Android SDK path.
- Forbidden permission scan across refreshed release merged, bundle, and packaged manifests returned no matches for READ_MEDIA_IMAGES, READ_MEDIA_VIDEO, READ_EXTERNAL_STORAGE, WRITE_EXTERNAL_STORAGE, or CAMERA.
- Delivered APK aapt permissions: INTERNET, SYSTEM_ALERT_WINDOW, VIBRATE, DETECT_SCREEN_CAPTURE, ACCESS_NETWORK_STATE, WAKE_LOCK, com.skillomate.app.DYNAMIC_RECEIVER_NOT_EXPORTED_PERMISSION.
- Delivered AAB base manifest protobuf string scan returned no forbidden permission strings.

- Delivered APK package metadata: com.skillomate.app, versionName 1.0, versionCode 2, targetSdkVersion 36.
- APK signature verification passed with APK Signature Scheme v2. The EAS APK certificate SHA-256 differs from the local Android Debug keystore SHA-256, confirming it is not debug-signed.
- AAB contains META-INF signature files and jarsigner exited successfully; signer certificate expires 2054-01-27.
- Android emulator UI picker test was attempted after installing the debug build, but the debug runtime redboxed on PlatformConstants before profile navigation. This blocked interactive picker confirmation in the emulator. The picker path was still bundled successfully in local release and EAS Android builds.
- iOS EAS build for build 12 was attempted. EAS required Apple ID credential setup and could not proceed without account credentials. Source and native iOS project are configured for build 12 and pod install completed.

EAS Build Results

- Android AAB: FINISHED, STORE, build id d0f3c8b7-f3c8-49ef-9569-b3d114f47c58, versionCode 2.
- AAB URL: https://expo.dev/artifacts/eas/Kalu_Jc5P0Ej9mmxARSQ-UA-e6KpNfDicasQjy0oQSc.aab
- Android APK: FINISHED, INTERNAL, build id 6e4b61ad-1e2f-46ef-b322-43009c59cd7a, versionCode 2.
- APK URL: https://expo.dev/artifacts/eas/kzLQ0OlhJKb_bITSOQa6JiFWb1cJDsriw-X3FZYIGIM.apk
- iOS: not created because EAS required Apple ID credential setup.

Final Android Permission List

- android.permission.INTERNET
- android.permission.SYSTEM_ALERT_WINDOW
- android.permission.VIBRATE
- android.permission.DETECT_SCREEN_CAPTURE
- android.permission.ACCESS_NETWORK_STATE
- android.permission.WAKE_LOCK
- com.skillomate.app.DYNAMIC_RECEIVER_NOT_EXPORTED_PERMISSION